

October

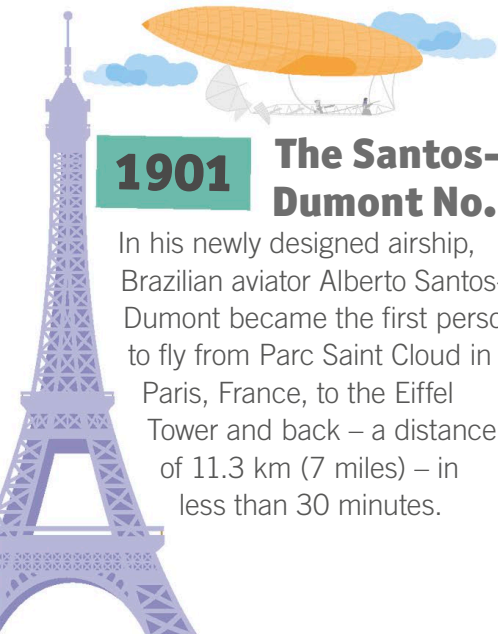
19



British surrender

1781

After losing at the Battle of Yorktown, British general Charles Cornwallis surrendered to US general George Washington. The defeat marked the end of the Revolutionary War and set a course towards American independence.



1901 The Santos-Dumont No. 6

In his newly designed airship, Brazilian aviator Alberto Santos-Dumont became the first person to fly from Parc Saint Cloud in Paris, France, to the Eiffel Tower and back – a distance of 11.3 km (7 miles) – in less than 30 minutes.

1872

The Holtermann Nugget

Gold miners in New South Wales, Australia, led by mine manager Bernhardt Holtermann, struck it rich when they unearthed the largest mass of reef gold ever discovered. The precious metal was found embedded in a large piece of quartz rock.



Born this day

1926 Marjorie Tallchief, ballet dancer. A member of the Osage Nation, she was the first Indigenous American to receive the title of principal dancer at the Paris Opera Ballet.

Also on this day

1469 King Ferdinand II of Aragon and Queen Isabella I of Castile were married, uniting the kingdoms of Aragon and Castile into a single country called Spain.

1914 Allied and German forces started to fight for control of the city of Ypres in Belgium during World War I.

1972 At Stanford University, USA, 24 gamers battled to win *Spacewar!* at the world's first video-game tournament.